

Yiming Zhao

3D Generalist



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Software:

Blender, Maya, Zbrush, Substance Painter, Substance Designer, Source Engine, Source 2, Unreal Engine 5

Skills:

Hand key animation, Fix retarget animations, High and low poly, modeling, Sculpting, Retopology. Rigging, UV, Baking, Texturing, Rendering

Education:

Pennsylvania State University
State College, PA 2021 – 2025

B.A. Digital Art & Media Design

Work Experience:

3D Generalist - Freelance

May 2020 - Dec 2024

- Created 12 player cosmetics to be sold in-game as part of official Team Fortress updates.
- Worked with concept artists to make sure the final product matches the artist design
- Modeled and rigged in Blender, textured in Substance Painter, created promotional arts in Blender and Photoshop.
- Animated player taunt in Blender with custom rig set up and pipelined files to be compatible within the game's engine.
- Created and ported custom prop assets to be used within official in-game maps.

3D Weapons Animator - Open Fortress

Feb 2019 - Feb 2020

- Used Blender to animate 12 weapons for Open Fortress, including pistols, shotgun, knife, rifle, throwables, multiple rocket and grenade launchers.

3D Animator - Team Fortress 2 Custom Boss

Aug 2023 - Dec 2023

- Rigged and animated NPC in Blender, worked with programmers to properly blend different layers of sequences to be used as map entity.
- Animated player taunt in Blender with custom rig set up and pipelined files to be compatible within the game's engine.

3D Animator - Netcode Warriors

Jun 2023 - Feb 2024

- Used given character rigs to create 2 cinematic attacks in the style of Guilty Gear Strive with manually posing each keyframe throughout the animations
- Modify / update existing character animations from feedback of the game director.

3D Animator - Confront (Student Film)

Apr 2024

- Created 2-minute animation in one month for final assignment, with an emphasis on composition, story, and build-ups
- Utilized Premiere Pro and Red Giant to compose multiple FX special effects together.
- Used Blender to create custom rigs and animations from existing characters, in addition to modeling the environment from scratch.

3D Animator - Team Fortress 2 Custom Game Mode

Dec 2023 - May 2025

- Created custom animation-ready rig set-up within Blender.
- Created over 300 animations for custom player models. Including 8-way third person locomotion movements for different weapons, view model animations, and taunts.